under someone else's influence. It's a different kind of expression for each lie.

God, I hate politicians.

Anyway, even when I've tried to, say, not be myself – diplomatic, oblique, indirect, even not necessarily straightforward about what's on my mind – people who know me and even people who don't can easily catch on to what I'm up to. That's my personality. That's my thing. I don't know if it's a weakness or strength. But it is what it is.

Sure, people become sober with age. I know I tried. It's natural. I can't satisfy everyone with my behaviour. But one can only try.

Pakistan is a tough place to tell the truth. My temperament is not suited to this country's culture of being scared to face the truth and general deceit. Not a lot of people will back you if you're on a mission to tell the truth. I've learnt this the hard way.

People, even important ones, have come up to me and said, 'Listen, you have a point and it may be the truth but don't bring it up on television.' At which point I have wondered, sometimes aloud: how else should I bring up the truth then? Alone? In a room? To the walls? It's been tough, this entire experience of trying, meagrely, to be honest and aboveboard. Thank God, I've been blamed for being a lot of things but never for being dishonest. I hope I can retain the ability to call a spade a spade. I just wish I stop getting into trouble for doing so.

On the field, my temperament has both helped and hurt us. In cricket, controlled aggression helps, especially when you're leading a team. If you're the captain and lack the aggression which the moment or the phase of that match demands, then you're done for. All eleven of you.

Attitude is contagious. And aggression – controlled aggression, I must reiterate – helps. Frankly, I think Pakistanis need a little bit of such calibrated aggression from their leaders. It's how we are structured as a people. Look at Imran Khan. He's the perfect example to bring up here. How's his political party faring? Not badly, eh. One reason, of course, is that he's not corrupt, at least not financially. Period. Let's hope things remain that way.

But the second element is his controlled aggression, combined with charisma. People love it when he speaks his mind. He does it so aggressively. He's a natural crowd-puller. I can't be classified in the same category as him, I'm nowhere near his status. But if, as prime minister, he aspires to improve Pakistan, all power to him. The truth needs a teller. I don't know if it's going to be him. But I hope Imran's leadership is good for Pakistan's future.

No doubt, Imran Khan has done a great deal for fighting corruption. What a movement he has led in Pakistan. But the question is: is his own house clean? If so, are his associates clean? Is his party, Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI), clean? That's a long list of very important questions. To really retain the moral high ground, Imran Khan will have to answer all those questions. If your own house isn't clean, then you don't look very good shouting at the other guy to clear his yard.

But my biggest gripe with Imran Khan is that he hasn't done enough for my hometown, Karachi. Nor have the rest of the cricketing powers.